



Look who's back

Vodafone India and Timbre Media will provide WorldSpace Radio on mobile handsets in India <http://dgit.in/GEHDFm>

Ultra low-cost smartphones

Sunil Mittal, CEO of Bharti Enterprises wants smartphone prices to come down to as low as \$50 (around ₹2,560) <http://dgit.in/GEK0ba>

Mozilla tackles walled gardens, demos "Boot to Gecko" mobile OS

Browser-maker Mozilla showed off the progress made on its Boot to Gecko project at Mobile World Congress. It's the development of a "complete, standalone operating system for the open Web".

The concept, first announced in July, is intended to do away with the "walled garden" approach of today's modern mobile operating systems", said Johnathan Nightingale, senior director of Firefox engineer.

Nightingale likened today's mobile OS situation to the



closed nature of Macs and PCs 10 years ago. "Now, if you buy an Android phone and you buy a bunch of apps for it and you get an iPad 2, you're out of luck. You need to buy those things again. And that doesn't feel great to us. How-

ever, when you peel back the covers, most of those apps are actually HTML5 Web apps with an added veneer for iOS, Android, or whatever store to which you're submitting."

"So we said, and this is what Boot to Gecko is, what if we just didn't do that? What if we just blow away that middle layer and say, the Web runs directly on the phone?" he said.

At MWC, Telefonica announced plans to support the creation of B2G-based open Web apps, as did Qualcomm, Adobe and Deutsche Telekom.

Nightingale demoed what B2G might look like on a Samsung Galaxy S II. After swiping to enter, up popped six tiles with options for the dialer, messages, browser (Firefox, naturally), maps, cameras, Facebook and more. The UI was bright and intuitive, and Nightingale easily swiped through the various screens and apps, playing video and launching a game.

Mozilla announced that its B2G app store is now open for submissions. More details are available at Mozilla.org [d](#)

Sony introduces the Xperia P, U and Sola

The Xperia P, Xperia U, and Xperia

Sola will run on a 1GHz dual-core NovaThor U8500 processor and Android 2.3 Gingerbread at launch in Q2 2012, but will get an Android 4.0 ICS upgrade soon after.

Prices haven't been revealed yet. All three devices are smaller versions of the Xperia S, and feature no SD card slot.

The Sony Xperia P – formerly known as the Xperia Nyphon – has a brushed aluminium finish, and runs on 1GB RAM. It has a 4-inch (540x960 pixel) resolution display with "WhiteMagic" technology, a 1080p HD-capable 8MP camera, front-facing VGA camera and NFC connectivity.



Sony Xperia U (Kumquat) features a colour-changing band at the bottom. It also features a 3.5-inch "Reality" display, 512MB RAM and a 5MP camera.

The Sony Xperia Sola (Pepper MT27i) has a "floating touch display" that will allow users to navigate with fingers a few millimetres above the touchscreen. It has a 3.7-inch display with the Mobile Bravia engine, 512MB RAM and a 5MP autofocus camera. [d](#)

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Nokia's 6 new mobiles

Nokia unveiled six devices at MWC: Lumia 610, Lumia 900, PureView 808 and Asha 302, 203 and 202. The two Lumia devices will release in Q2 2012, along with the PureView 808, while the Asha devices will release within the next few weeks.

The Nokia PureView 808 stole the show with a 41MP camera phone running Symbian Belle. The Nokia Lumia 610 is the first low-cost Windows Phone handset around, running WP7.5 Mango on an 800MHz Snapdragon S1 processor, 256MB RAM and 8GB of built-in storage.



It will be priced at roughly ₹12,500 when launched.

The top-end Nokia Windows Phone, the global-edition Lumia 900, was also introduced, featuring HSPA+ connectivity instead of LTE – it's expected to launch at ₹31,500. The Nokia Asha 302 is a QWERTY device, with social networking and IM integration as well as Microsoft Exchange. It should

be available for roughly ₹6,500. The Nokia Asha 202 / 203 (dual-SIM variant) are Touch N Type offerings, with 2.4-inch resistive touch displays. Both devices will be priced at roughly, ₹4,000, and ship with roughly ₹75 (₹6,084) worth of EA Games. [d](#)